

Caffeine and vigilance in shift workers: a field study

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ABSTRACT

In a field study of night-shift nurses, caffeine increased sustained attention scores during the final hours of the shift. Benefits were largest for non-habitual consumers.

METHODS

n = 64 night-shift nurses completed the Psychomotor Vigilance Task with and without 150 mg caffeine.

RESULTS

Caffeine significantly increased sustained attention scores at 5 a.m. (mean difference 3.1 points, $p = 0.008$).